

Website Design



BIT 1204 - Fundamental of Web Development

● introduction

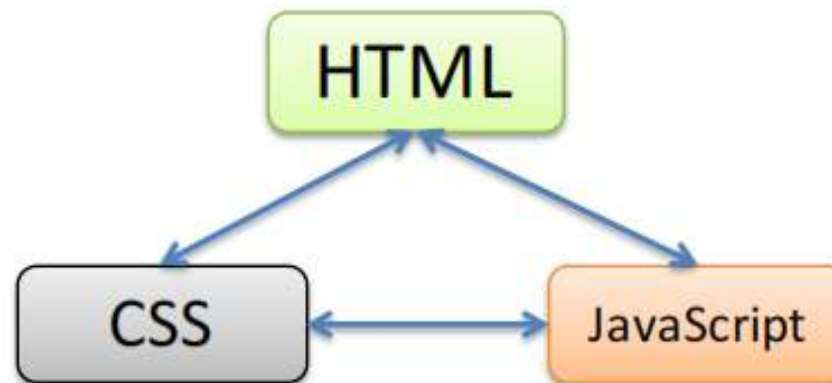
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● examples

@ MMU 2023 Department of Computer Science

Introduction to Web Development Concepts

Web Programming



Step by step Exercises



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What is a Website? (+ How it Works)



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What is a webpage?

A web page is a document that is suitable for the web browsers.

A web page is a document that we write using HTML language.

Modern webpage contains three components.

1. HTML Content
2. Style Information
3. Scripting Language



Thank You



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Website?

- The **Web (World Wide Web)** consists of information organized into Web pages containing text and graphic images.
- It contains hypertext links, or highlighted keywords and images that lead to related information.
- A collection of linked Web pages that has a common theme or focus is called a **Web site**.
- The main page that all of the pages on a particular Web site are organized around and link back to is called the site's **home page**.



WHAT IS THE PURPOSE OF A WEBSITE?



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WEBSITE PURPOSE

1. AWARENESS

2. SALES

3. INFORMATION



What is your website's primary purpose?

to sell

to generate leads

to inform

to entertain

to serve

to present

to connect

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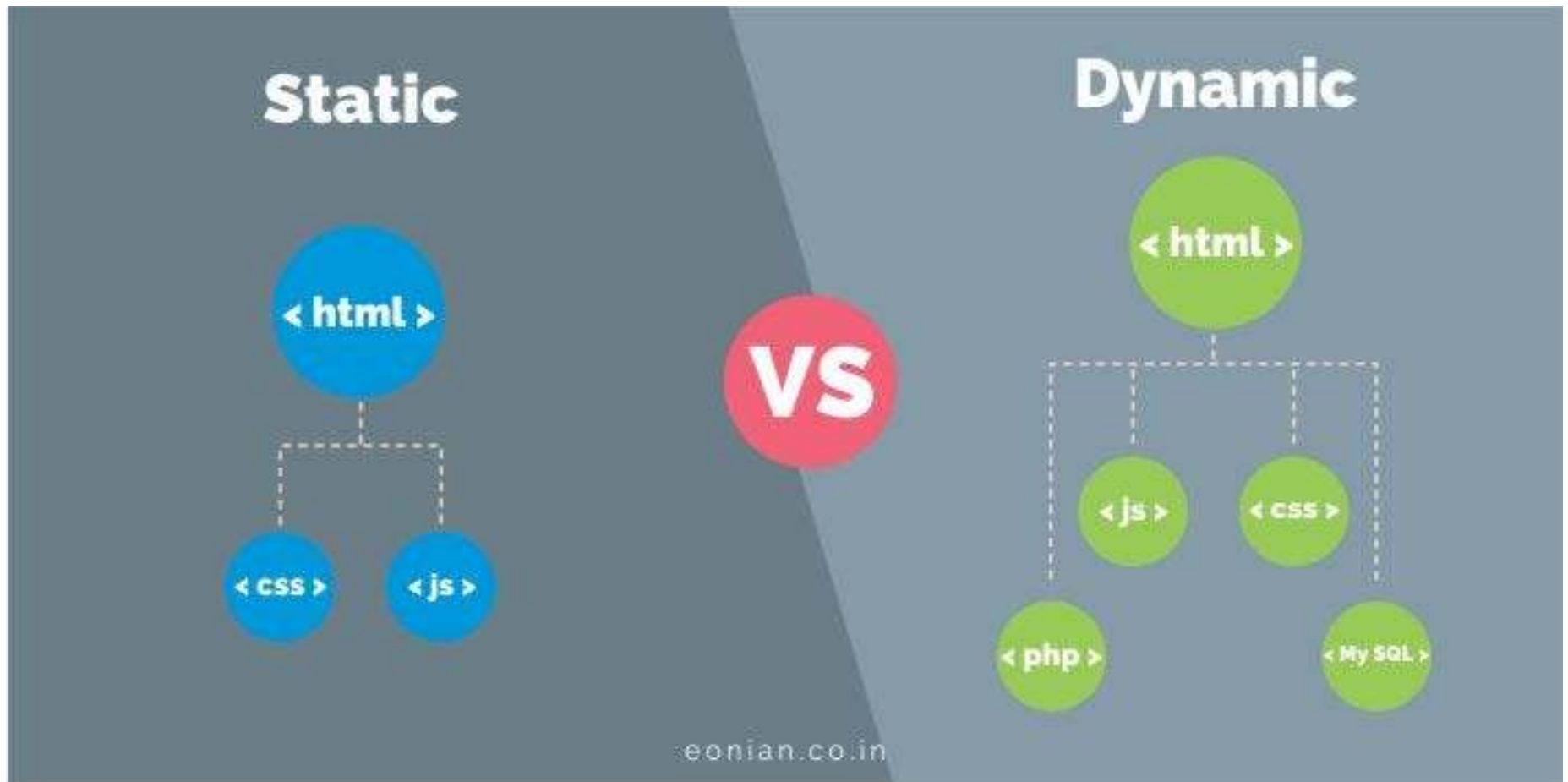


WEBSITE CATEGORIES

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Main Categories of Websites

Static Websites

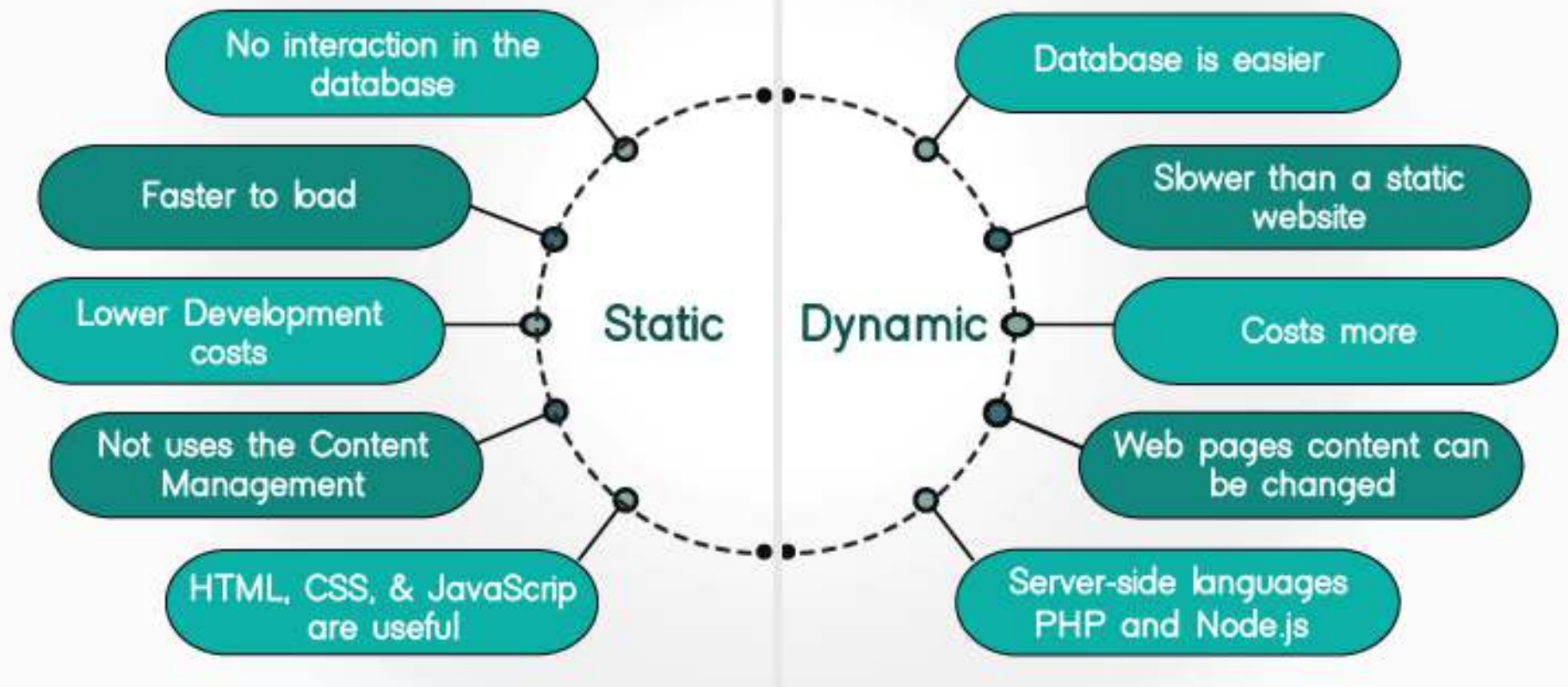
- Just like the name suggests, static websites consist of web pages whose content does not dynamically change. The content is indeed static. Many times, these websites are designed in plain HTML (Hyper-Text Markup Language), CSS (Cascading Style Sheets) and JavaScript. All website content is stored in the individual website files. Not in databases. We can therefore say they are “not database driven”.

Dynamic Websites

- Dynamic websites consist of web pages with dynamic content. This means, their content is ever changing.



Comparison of The Static & Dynamic Website



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A static site is one that is usually written in plain HTML and what is in the code of the page is what is displayed to the user.

```

1 <!DOCTYPE html PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD XHTML 1.0 Transitional//EN"
2 "http://www.w3.org/TR/xhtml1/DTD/xhtml1-transitional.dtd">
3 <html>
4 <head>
5   <meta content="HTML Tidy for Windows (vers 12 April 2005), see www.w3.org" name="generator">
6   <meta http-equiv="content-type" content="text/html; charset=UTF-8" />
7   <meta content="" />
8   <!-- A place to learn about computer software, security and games, popular physics, life, 3d art, and mini mobile
9   art, and much more! -->
10   <meta content="" name="keywords">
11   <title>
12     <!-- A place to learn about computer software, security and games, popular physics, life, 3d art, media, and more -->
13   </title>
14   <link type="text/css" rel="stylesheet" href="css/default.css">
15   <link type="text/css" rel="stylesheet" href="css/custom_style.css">
16   <link rel="shortcut icon" href="images/site_icon.svg">
17   <link rel="alternate" type="application/rss+xml" title="RSS" href="rss_feed.xml">
18 </head>
19 <body>
20   <a href="http://www.dedimemo.com/"></a>
21   <div class="banner">
22     <a href="http://www.dedimemo.com/?tag=2016">Banner: 2016</a>
23     <a href="http://www.dedimemo.com/images/banner2.jpg"></a>
24   </div>
25   <div class="content_area">
26     <div>
27       <div>
28         <a href="http://www.dedimemo.com/computer_software.html">Software</a>
29       </div>
30       <div>
31         <a href="http://www.dedimemo.com/computer_games.html">Computer games</a>
32       </div>
33     </div>
34   </div>

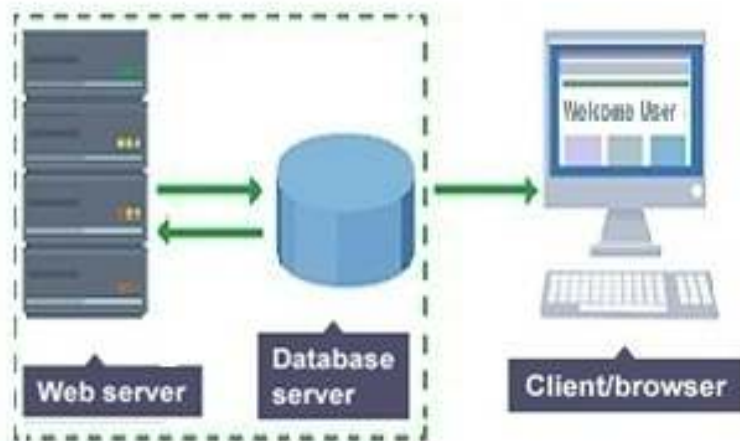
```

```

1 <!doctype>
2 <html lang="en">
3   <head>
4     <meta charset="utf-8">
5     <meta name="Keywords" content="mark ammay, etc">
6     <meta name="Description" content="Mark Ammay...">
7     <meta name="author" content="Mark Ammay">
8     <meta name="ROBOTS" content="INDEX,FOLLOW">
9     <title>Web Code Central</title>
10    <link rel="stylesheet" href="css/reset.css" type="text/css" media="screen" />
11  </head>
12  <body>
13    <!--start contactable -->
14    <script type="text/javascript" src="js/jquery.validate.pack.js"></script>
15    <script type="text/javascript" src="js/jquery.contactable.js"></script>
16    <link rel="stylesheet" href="css/contactable.css" type="text/css" />
17    <script>(function(){if('#contactable').contactable({subject: 'feedback (URL: ' + location
18      .href)}));</script>
19    <!--end contactable -->
20    <div id="wrapper">
21      <header id="top">
22        <group>
23          <a href="#" class="logo">
24            <img alt="Mark Ammay logo" />

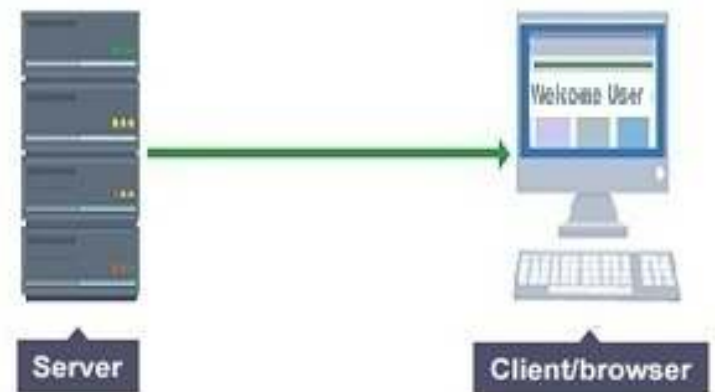
```

Dynamic Website



Vs.

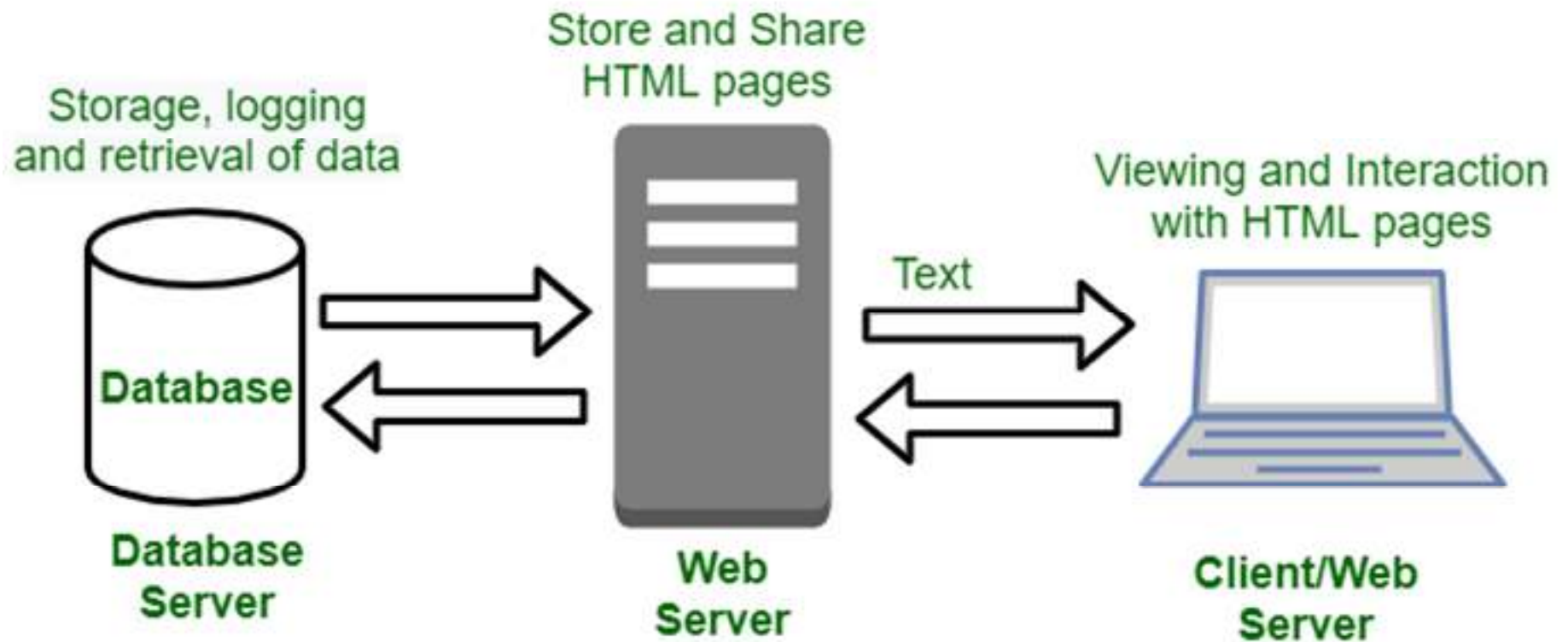
Static Website



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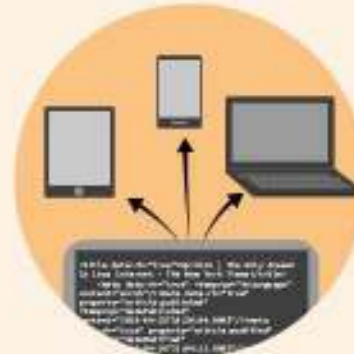
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A Day in the Life of a Web Developer

Build user interfaces and prototypes from wireframes and designs



Code and deploy applications in a cross-platform, cross-browser environment



Build products using HTML/CSS/JS



Update current websites to meet modern web standards



Career opportunities in Web site design field

- Formal Employment opportunities
 - Web Development
 - Web Administration
 - Webmaster (manager)
- Informal Sector
 - Developer
 - Freelancer Tasks



WEBSITE  DESIGN

PRINCIPLES

FOR BEGINNERS

1

SIMPLE IS THE BEST

The over-designed website may not work but simplicity always works in an effective web page design.

2

CONSISTENCY

Consistency in site design matters. Give your attention to match design elements throughout the site.

3

EASY NAVIGATION

Study shows that visitors stay more time on the websites having easy navigation.

4

READABILITY

No matter how good your design is text still rules the website as it provides users the desired information,

5

MOBILE FRIENDLY

Keeping in mind the ever-growing usage of small screens, web site design must be effective.

6

EASY LOADING

No one likes the website that takes too much time to load. So take care of your site by optimizing things.

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More Principles Of Good Website Design

By Vitaly Friedman

- Scholarly Perspective!
- Usability and the utility, not the visual design, determine the success or failure of a web-site. Since the visitor of the page is the only person who clicks the mouse and therefore decides everything, user-centric design has become a standard approach for successful and profit-oriented web design. After all, if users can't use a feature, it might as well not exist.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Don't make users think**
- According to Krug's first law of usability, the web-page should be obvious and self-explanatory. When you're creating a site, your job is to get rid of the question marks — the decisions users need to make consciously, considering pros, cons and alternatives. People won't use your web site if they can't find their way around it.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Don't squander users' patience**
- In every project when you are going to offer your visitors some service or tool, try to keep your user requirements minimal. The less action is required from users to test a service, the more likely a random visitor is to actually try it out. First-time visitors are willing to **play with the service**, not filling long web forms for an account they might never use in the future. Let users explore the site and discover your services without forcing them into sharing private data. It's not reasonable to force users to enter an email address to test the feature.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Manage to focus users' attention**
- As web-sites provide both static and dynamic content, some aspects of the user interface attract attention more than others do. Obviously, images are more eye-catching than the text — just as the sentences marked as bold are more attractive than plain text.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Strive for feature exposure**
- Modern web designs are usually criticized due to their approach of guiding users with visually appealing 1-2-3-done-steps, large buttons with visual effects etc. But from the design perspective these elements actually aren't a bad thing. On the contrary, such **guidelines are extremely effective** as they lead the visitors through the site content in a very simple and user-friendly way.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Make use of effective writing**
- As the Web is different from print, it's necessary to adjust the writing style to users' preferences and browsing habits.
- Promotional writing won't be read. Long text blocks without images and keywords marked in **bold** or *italics* will be skipped. Exaggerated language will be ignored.
- use short and concise phrases (come to the point as quickly as possible)



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Strive for simplicity**
- The “keep it simple”-principle (KIS) should be the primary goal of site design. Users are rarely on a site to enjoy the design; furthermore, in most cases they are looking for the information *despite* the design. Strive for simplicity instead of complexity.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By Vitaly Friedman

- **Don't be afraid of the white space** Actually it's really hard to overestimate the importance of white space.
- Not only does it help to **reduce the cognitive load** for the visitors, but it makes it possible to perceive the information presented on the screen. When a new visitor approaches a design layout, the first thing he/she tries to do is to scan the page and divide the content area into digestible pieces of information.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Communicate effectively with a “visible language”**
- **Organize:** provide the user with a clear and consistent conceptual structure. screen layout, relationships and navigability are important concepts of organization.
- **Economize:** Four major points to be considered: simplicity, clarity, distinctiveness, and emphasis. **Communicate:** match the presentation to the capabilities of the user. The user interface must keep in balance legibility, readability, typography, symbolism, multiple views, and color or texture in order to communicate successfully. Use **max. 3 typefaces in a maximum of 3 point sizes** — a maximum of 18 words or 50-80 characters per line of text.



Principles Of Good Website Design

By [Vitaly Friedman](#)

- **Test early, test often**
- This so-called TETO-principle should be applied to every web design project as usability tests often provide **crucial insights** into significant problems and issues related to a given layout.
- Test not too late, not too little and not for the wrong reasons. In the latter case it's necessary to understand that most design decisions are local; that means that you can't universally answer whether some layout is better than the other one as you need to analyze it from a very specific point of view (considering requirements, stakeholders, budget etc.).

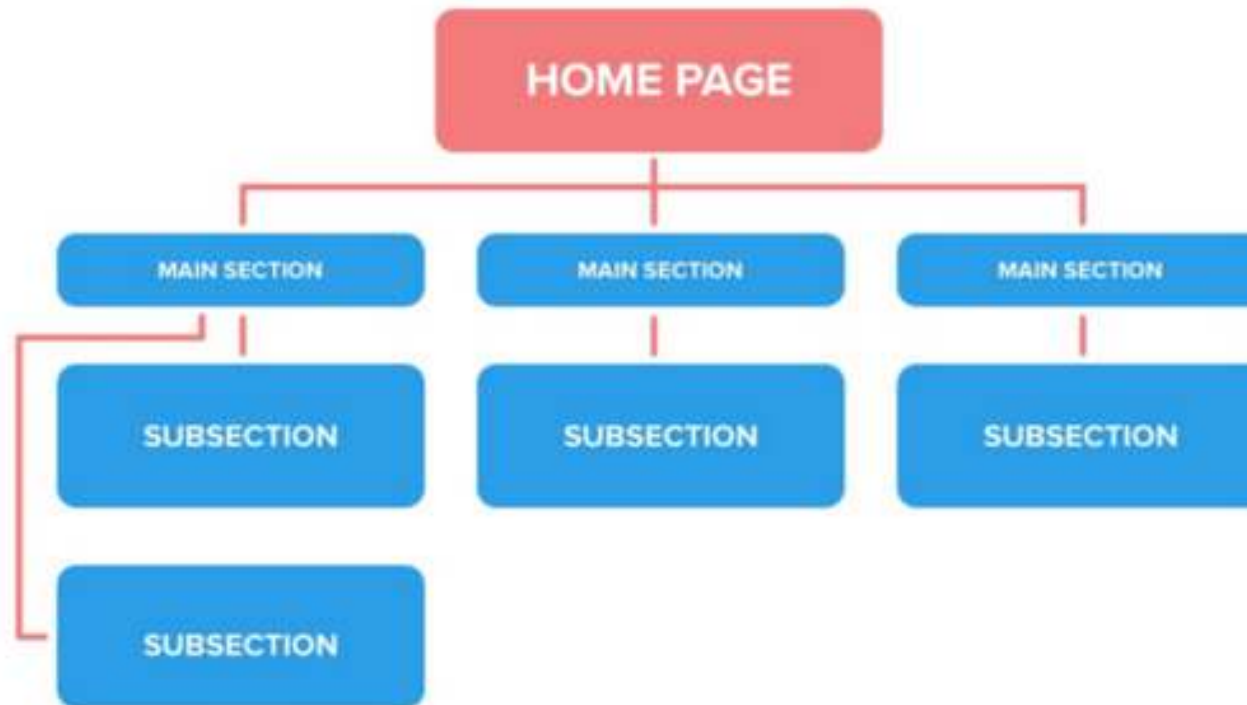


Web site structure?

- Site structure refers to how you organize your website's content. A website often consists of content on a variety of – related – topics, presented on posts and pages.
- Site structure deals with how this content is grouped, linked and presented to the visitor. If you structure your website well, it will benefit from this; users will find their way more easily and Google can index your URLs better.



What is site structure?

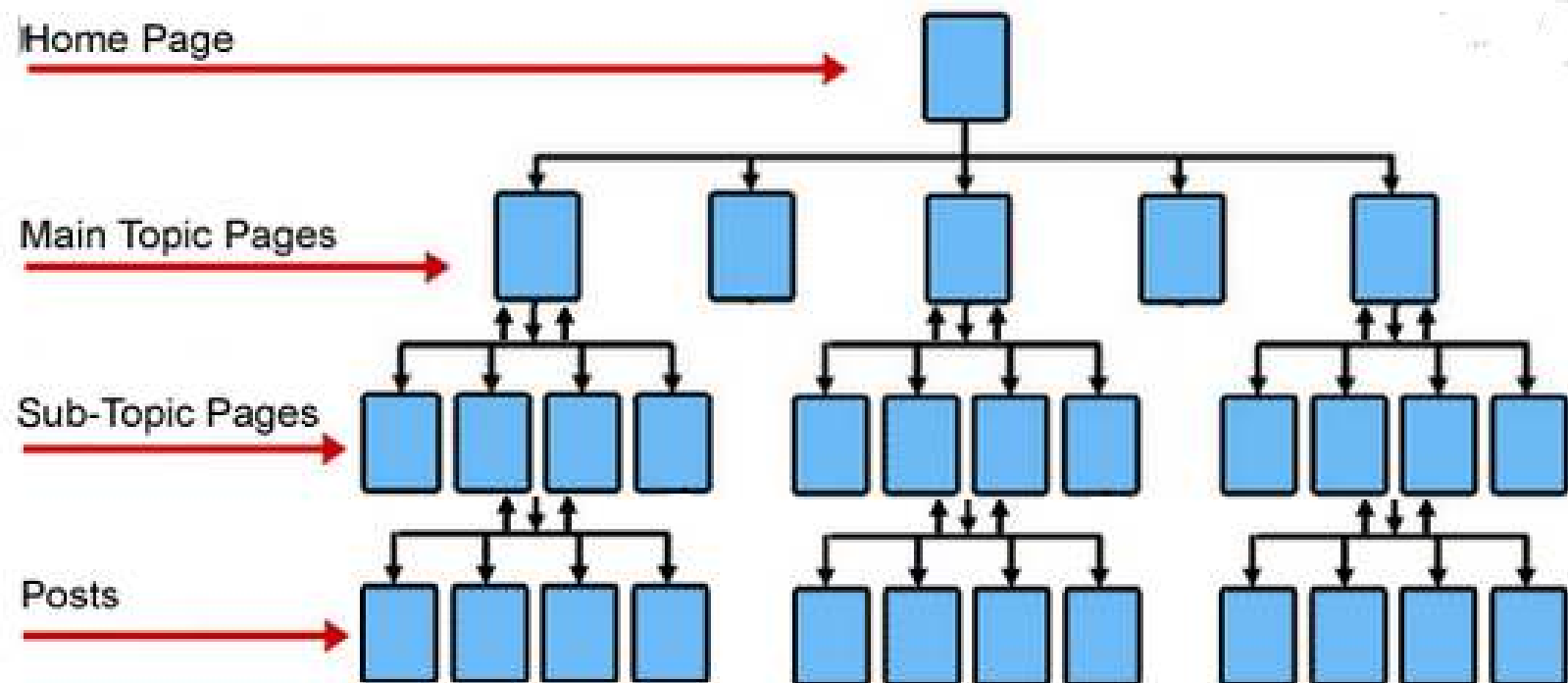


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What is site structure?



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IGAD LEADERS DISCUSS SOUTH SUDAN, LOCUSTS INVASION



Regional leaders were at 34th Extraordinary summit of the assembly of IGAD in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

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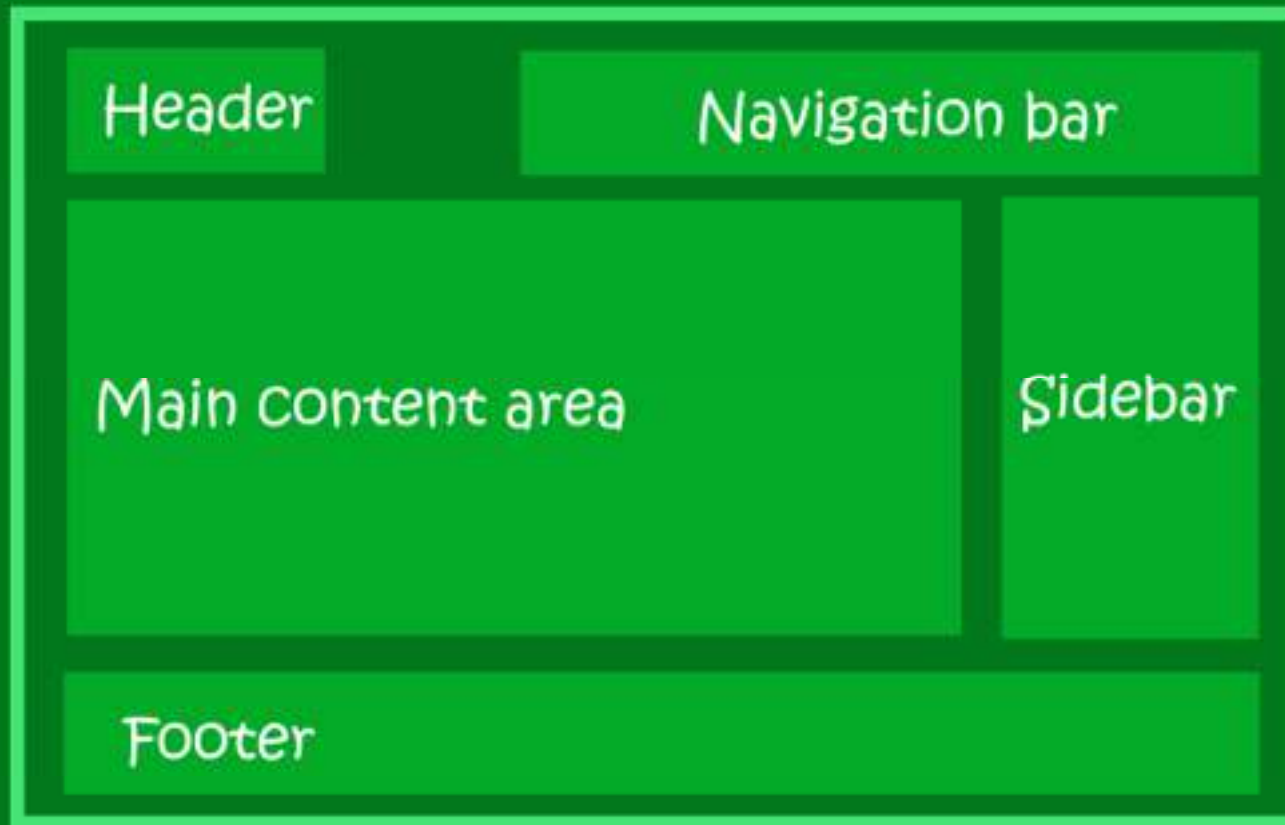
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website layout

- A **website layout** is a pattern (or framework) that defines a **website's** structure.
- It has the role of structuring the information present on a **site** both for the **website's** owner and for users.
- It provides clear paths for navigation within webpages and puts the most important elements of a **website** front and center



Main Parts of a Web page



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Footer	▼	Navigation
Sidebar	▼	Content
Buttons	▼	CTA

Header	▼
Body	▼
Images	▼



Planning a Website

- As the old adage goes, *if you fail to plan, you plan to fail.*
- Building a website without a plan is like constructing a building without blueprints.
- Things end up in the wrong place, features are overlooked, and the situation is ripe for miscommunication between website builder and client.



Practical Steps For Planning a Website

- Set your purpose and goals.
- Create a budget.
- Assign roles.
- Create a content strategy.
- Structure your website
- Create a mock-up
- Start designing
- Test it out.
- Maintain your site.



What is Content Management?

- A computer software system for organizing and facilitating collaborative creation of documents and other content, especially for loading to a website
- Content can include: web pages, images, documents, streaming media, news releases, etc.
- A CMS usually consists of a front-end editor for inputting content and a back end system for storing the content (usually a database).
- This content can then be formatted by a template and displayed in a variety of ways.

